

Word family: **straight / straighter / straightest / straighten / straightforward / straightaway**

Base word: straight

Comparative: straighter

Superlative: straightest

Related forms: straighten, straightforward, straightaway

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / noun-related fixed uses (部分固定名詞用法)

Your sentence:

> "...the tiny details that most of us walk **straight** past."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **straight** means **directly, without stopping, turning aside, or paying attention to something along the way**.

The speaker means that most people pass these small details without noticing them at all.

繁體中文： **直接地繼續前進，中途不停下、不偏離，也沒有留意旁邊的事物**

中文翻譯：

> "...the tiny details that most of us walk **straight past**."

「.....那些大部分人都會**直接走過而沒有留意**的小細節。」

Here:

walk straight past something = 直接從某物旁邊走過，沒有停下或留意它

The original sentence therefore uses **straight** as an adverb describing the directness of movement.

1. **straight = not curved/bent (形狀 / 線條) — 直的；筆直的**

This is one of the basic adjective meanings.

Meaning: Extending in one direction without bending, curving, or turning.

Practice 1

> "Draw a **straight** line across the page."

「在紙上畫一條**直線**。」

Practice 2

> “The road is almost perfectly **straight** for several kilometres.”

「這條路有幾公里幾乎都是完全**筆直的**。」

****straight = 形狀或路線沒有彎曲、轉折或偏離方向的****

Common:

- * straight line
- * straight road
- * straight edge
- * straight hair

However, *straight hair* refers specifically to hair that is not curly or wavy. This still grows naturally from the broader “not curved” concept, so it does not need a separate core meaning.

2. ****straight = upright/aligned properly (位置 / 姿勢) — 挺直的 ; 端正的 ; 整齊排列的****

Here, ****straight**** describes something correctly aligned rather than leaning, twisted, or crooked.

Practice 3

> “Sit up ****straight****.”

「坐**直 / 坐端正**。」

Practice 4

> “Is this picture ****straight****?”

「這幅畫掛得**正不正 / 有沒有歪**？」

****straight = 處於正確、端正或整齊的方向，沒有傾斜或歪曲****

This is closely related to the physical “not bent/crooked” concept.

For database purposes, I would merge it with Meaning 1 under the broader physical idea of:

> ****not curved, crooked, tilted, or misaligned****

The Golden Manual says not to create separate meanings merely because the physical context changes when one broader semantic concept explains them naturally.

3. ****go/walk/drive straight (移動方向) — 一直向前 ; 直走****

As an adverb, ****straight**** means moving directly forward without turning.

Practice 5

> “Go ****straight**** for two blocks, then turn left.”

「****一直向前走****兩個街口，然後左轉。」

Practice 6

> “She drove ****straight**** ahead at the junction.”

「她在路口****一直向前駛****。」

****straight = 朝同一方向直接前進，不轉彎或偏離路線****

This is one of the main adverbial meanings.

4. ****straight to/from/past + place/person (直接到 / 從 / 經過) — 直接 ; 不繞路 ; 不停留****

This is the meaning closest to your passage.

****Meaning:**** Directly from one place, person, action, or situation to another without interruption or diversion.

Practice 7 — Original

> “Most of us walk ****straight past**** those tiny details.”

「我們大部分人都會****直接走過****那些細小的細節而沒有留意。」

Practice 8

> “After work, she went ****straight home****.”

「下班後，她****直接回家****。」

Practice 9

> “He walked **straight past me** without saying hello.”

「他**直接從我身旁走過**，連招呼也沒有打。」

straight + direction/destination = 不停下、不繞路、不轉去其他地方，而直接前往或經過某處

Common:

- * straight home
- * straight to bed
- * straight to work
- * straight past someone
- * straight through

I would keep this as the same broader **direct movement** sense as Meaning 3, rather than counting each construction separately.

5. **straight** = direct/immediate without interruption (時間 / 次序) — 連續地；直接地

The idea of “no deviation” can extend from physical direction to time and sequence.

Practice 10

> “He worked for ten hours **straight**.”

「他**連續**工作了十個小時。」

Practice 11

> “It rained for three days **straight**.”

「雨**連續**下了三天。」

for + period + straight = 某件事情連續發生整段時間，中間沒有中斷

This is no longer about physical direction, so it deserves separate treatment.

6. **straight** = consecutive (連續的) — 連續的；接連的

As an adjective, **straight** can mean consecutive, especially with numbers of wins, days, years, etc.

Practice 12

> “The team won five **straight** games.”

「這支球隊**連勝五場**。」

Practice 13

> “She worked seven **straight** days without a break.”

「她**連續**工作了七天，期間沒有休息。」

straight + number/time/event = 同類事情一個接一個連續發生，中間沒有中斷

This belongs to the same broader temporal-continuity concept as Meaning 5.

So for core counting, I would merge:

> ten hours straight

> five straight wins

under:

> **continuous / consecutive without interruption**

7. **straight = honest/direct/frank (說話 / 態度) — 直接的；坦率的；不拐彎抹角的**

This is a common figurative meaning.

Meaning: Honest and direct, without trying to hide, soften, or avoid the truth.

Practice 14

> “Give me a **straight** answer.”

「給我一個**直接、坦率的答覆**。」

Practice 15

> “She was very **straight** with me about the problem.”

「她對這個問題跟我說得非常****坦白直接****。」

****straight = 表達意見或回答時坦率直接，不迴避、不含糊或刻意掩飾****

This figuratively develops from the idea:

> no bending → no verbal or conceptual detour

But for learners it is clearly distinct from physical straightness.

8. ****straight = correct/clear/organized (資料 / 事情) — 清楚正確；整理好的****

A related figurative use appears in expressions such as:

> get something straight

> set the record straight

Practice 16

> “Let me get this ****straight****: you already knew about the problem?”

「讓我先把事情****弄清楚****：你早就知道這個問題？」

Practice 17

> “She wanted to set the record ****straight****.”

「她想把事情真相****澄清 / 說清楚****。」

****straight = 資料、理解或說法處於清楚、正確、不混亂的狀態****

I would treat this as a useful figurative branch rather than merge it completely with “honest/direct,” because the mental concept is more about ****correct order/clarity****.

9. ****straight = conventional/not altered or mixed (純粹 / 正常形式) — 純的；不加其他東西的****

In some contexts, ****straight**** means something is taken or presented in its ordinary, unmixed, or unmodified form.

Practice 18

> “He drinks his coffee ****straight****, without milk or sugar.”

「他喝咖啡時甚麼都不加，直接喝**純咖啡**。」

Practice 19

> “She preferred a **straight** factual account of what happened.”

「她比較想聽一個**純粹按事實、沒有花巧加工的**事件描述。」

The exact Chinese depends heavily on context.

The broader idea is:

****straight = 沒有加入其他成分、變化、修飾或複雜處理的****

However, some expressions of this type are fairly collocational, so I would be conservative about expanding this sense too widely.

10. ****straight = heterosexual (性取向) — 異性戀的****

This is an established modern adjective meaning.

Practice 20

> “The survey included gay, bisexual, and **straight** participants.”

「這項調查包括同性戀、雙性戀及**異性戀**參與者。」

Practice 21

> “He identifies as **straight**.”

「他認同自己的性取向是**異性戀**。」

****straight = 在性取向方面主要受到異性吸引的；異性戀的****

This is completely different from physical straightness and therefore clearly deserves its own entry.

Register:

****common modern English; generally informal-to-neutral****

11. **a straight (撲克) — 順子**

As a noun in card games, especially poker, **a straight** means a hand containing cards in consecutive numerical order.

Practice 22

> “He won the hand with a **straight**.”

「他以一副**順子**贏了這一局。」

Practice 23

> “A **straight** consists of five cards in sequence.”

「**順子**由五張點數連續的牌組成。」

a straight = 在撲克等紙牌遊戲中，由連續點數牌組成的一種牌型

This is domain-specific but common enough to be recognized in ordinary English.

Related form: **straighten**

Straighten means to make something straight, orderly, or properly aligned.

straighten + physical object — 弄直；擺正

Practice 24

> “She **straightened** the picture on the wall.”

「她把牆上的畫**擺正**。」

Practice 25

> “He stood up and **straightened** his back.”

「他站起來，把背部**挺直**。」

straighten = 令原本彎曲、傾斜或不整齊的東西變直或端正

Related form: **straightforward**

****Straightforward**** is a highly useful lexical extension.

It means:

1. simple and easy to understand or do; or
2. honest and direct.

Practice 26

> “The instructions are very ****straightforward****.”

「這些指示非常****簡單清楚、容易理解****。」

Practice 27

> “She was ****straightforward**** about what she wanted.”

「她很****坦率直接地****說出自己想要甚麼。」

****straightforward** = 不複雜、容易理解的；或說話做事坦白直接的******

This is a family extension, not simply another grammatical form of ****straight****.

Related form: ****straightaway****

Especially in British English:

****straightaway** = immediately******

Practice 28

> “I knew ****straightaway**** that something was wrong.”

「我****立刻****就知道有些事情不對勁。」

Practice 29

> “Please call me ****straightaway**** if anything changes.”

「如果有任何變化，請****立即****打電話給我。」

****straightaway** = 沒有延誤地立刻做某件事；馬上******

This develops from the broad “directly, without interruption” idea.

Important distinction: **straight vs directly**

These often overlap.

straight

can emphasize:

- * no turning
- * no interruption
- * no detour

> “Go straight home.”

directly

can mean:

- * without an intermediate step;
- * immediately;
- * in a direct manner.

> “Please contact me directly.”

In your sentence:

> “walk **straight past**”

straight strongly emphasizes simply continuing onward without stopping.

Important distinction: **straight vs right**

Both can mean “directly” in some expressions, but they are not generally interchangeable.

> “Go **straight** ahead.”

= 一直向前。

> “Go **right** ahead.”

can mean:

= 儘管做吧 / 請繼續。

So learners should not equate them simply because both can intensify direction in certain phrases.

Important distinction: **straight vs direct**

straight

often describes shape, direction, continuity, or manner:

- > straight road
- > walk straight home

direct

often describes the relationship or route between two points without intermediaries:

- > direct flight
- > direct contact

A road can be:

- > **straight but indirect**

if it happens to go in the wrong overall direction.

And a route can be:

- > **direct but not straight**

if it curves while still being the most immediate route.

So the two concepts overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: **straight vs upright**

straight

= not bent, curved, crooked, or misaligned

upright

= vertical / standing in a vertical position

> “Keep your back straight.”

> “Keep the bottle upright.”

An object may be physically straight but lying horizontally, so **straight ≠ upright**.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **straight**
* **straighter**
* **straightest**
* **straighten**
* **straightforward**
* **straightaway**

Useful fixed expressions include:

* **go straight**
* **straight ahead**
* **straight past**
* **for hours straight**
* **give a straight answer**
* **get something straight**
* **set the record straight**

These should not all be manufactured into separate meanings merely because the phrase changes. The Manual specifically requires a second-pass merging check and says fixed expressions should be attached to the closest relevant sense where appropriate.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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straight — physical shape/alignment	沒有彎曲、歪斜或偏離正確方向；筆直、端正或排列整齊的
go/walk straight	朝同一方向直接前進，中途不轉彎或偏離

straight to/past/from somewhere	不停下、不繞路或不轉去其他地方，而直接前往、離開或經過某處	
period/event + straight	某件事情連續發生一段時間或若干次，中間沒有中斷	
straight — frank/direct	說話、回答或態度坦率直接，不迴避、不含糊或刻意掩飾	
straight — correct/clear	資料、理解或說法被整理至清楚、正確、不混亂的狀態	
straight — unmixed/unmodified	沒有加入其他成分、變化或額外處理，保持純粹或原本形式	
straight — heterosexual	性取向主要受到異性吸引的；異性戀的	
a straight — cards	在撲克等紙牌遊戲中，由連續點數的牌構成的一種牌型	
straighten	令原本彎曲、傾斜或不整齊的東西變得筆直或端正	
straightforward	簡單清楚、容易理解或處理的；亦可指坦率直接的	
straightaway	沒有延誤地立即做某件事；馬上	

For your original sentence

> “...the tiny details that most of us walk ****straight past****.”

The exact meaning is:

****straight = 直接地繼續前進，中途不停下或轉向****

More specifically:

****walk straight past something = 直接從某物旁邊走過，完全沒有停下來或特別留意****

So:

> ****the tiny details that most of us walk straight past****

= ****那些大部分人會直接走過而忽略掉的細小細節****

For your database, I would count ****7 genuinely useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****straight****:

1. ****physically straight / not curved, crooked, or misaligned****
2. ****move directly without turning or deviating****
3. ****continuous / consecutive without interruption****
4. ****frank, honest, or direct****
5. ****clear/correct/put in proper order****
6. ****unmixed or unmodified****
7. ****heterosexual****

Then I would keep ****a straight = poker hand**** as a useful domain-specific noun sense, while treating ****straighten, straightforward, straightaway****, and constructions such as ****straight past / set the record straight**** as family or fixed-expression extensions rather than inflating the base-word count.